

UNITED ACCREDITATION FOUNDATION



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**ACCREDITATION REQUIREMENTS FOR
CERTIFICATION OF QUALITY MANAGEMENT
SYSTEMS (QMS)**

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1. ACCREDITATION REQUIREMENTS

This scheme document establishes additional scheme-specific accreditation requirements applicable to certification bodies performing certification against the applicable management system standard covered under this scheme. These requirements supplement the applicable accreditation standards, including UAF-GEN-CAB-01 — General Accreditation Requirements and UAF-GEN-CAB-02 — General Rules and Conditions for Use of UAF Accreditation Mark, together with other applicable international mandatory documents and normative references identified in this document.

Accreditation of Certification Bodies under this scheme shall be granted and maintained in accordance with the following requirements:

- ISO/IEC 17021-1 — Conformity assessment — Requirements for bodies providing audit and certification of management systems.
- UAF-GEN-CAB-01 — General Accreditation Requirements.
- UAF-GEN-CAB-02 — General Rules and Conditions for Use of UAF Accreditation Mark.
- Applicable IAF/GACI Mandatory Documents and other normative documents referenced in this scheme document.

In case of any ambiguity, difference in interpretation, or lack of clarity between this scheme document and other applicable UAF accreditation documents and policies, clarification shall be obtained from UAF. The interpretation or guidance provided by UAF shall be considered final for the purposes of accreditation.

2. ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTS

ISO and IAF/GACI documents applicable for accreditation of ISO 9001 certification

- ISO/IEC 17021-3:2017 Conformity assessment – Requirements for bodies providing audit and certification of management systems – Part 3: Competence requirements for auditing and certification of Quality Management Systems
- IAF MD 1 IAF Mandatory Document for the Audit and Certification of a Management System Operated by a Multi-Site Organization
- IAF MD 2 IAF Mandatory Document for the Transfer of Accredited Certification of Management Systems.
- IAF MD 4 IAF Mandatory Document for the Use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) for Auditing/Assessment Purposes
- IAF MD 5 Determination of Audit Time of Quality, Environmental, and Occupational Health & Safety Management Systems.
- IAF MD 11 IAF Mandatory Document for Application of ISO/IEC 17021 for Audits of Integrated Management Systems (IMS)
- IAF MD 23 Control of Entities Operating on Behalf of Accredited Management Systems Certification Bodies
- IAF MD 28 IAF Mandatory Document for the Upload and Maintenance of Data on IAF Database

3. UAF ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTS APPLICABLE FOR ACCREDITATION OF ISO 9001 CERTIFICATIONS

- UAF-GEN-CAB-01-General Accreditation requirements
- UAF-GEN-CAB-02-Conditions for the use of UAF Symbol
- UAF-PL:2014-01: Policy on Providing Certification Activities in Foreign Countries Where Regulatory Approval or Authorization is Required.
- UAF F-31A-Annexure A- Guidance for the addition of countries, locations and critical

Locations.

- UAF-PL:2016-06: UAF Policy for the Collection of Data to Provide Indicators of Management System Certification Bodies' Performance as per IAF MD 15:2014.
- UAF-PL:2018-04: UAF Policy on handling misconduct & unethical practices in the certification process
- UAF-PL:2019-07-01: UAF Policy on accreditation scopes & witnessing activities for accreditation of management system CB
- UAF-PL:2019-07-02: UAF Policy regarding general administration
- UAF-PL:2020-03-02: UAF Policy for handling extraordinary events or circumstances affecting UAF Accredited CABs on their certified clients/persons.
- UAF-PL:2020-03-03: UAF Policy on Remote Assessment
- UAF-PL:2023-09-01: UAF Policy for CAB operations in Sanctioned Countries
- UAF-PL:2024-02-01: UAF policy regarding the consideration of climate change within the organizational context of the management system

4. CERTIFICATION DOCUMENTS

Certification Bodies (CAB) certifying against ISO 9001 – Quality Management Systems – Requirements with guidance for use

5. SCOPE OF ACCREDITATION

The scope of accreditation is defined based on listing 39 IAF groups/codes divided into 14 technical clusters as detailed in the table at serial number 17 of this document. UAF may further restrict scope to specific NACE code/IAF Group Code within a technical cluster mentioned in the table in case:

- The CB requests so.
- The assessment in the opinion of UAF, does not allow granting accreditation for a complete cluster. This could be the case when the cluster represents a large diversity of technical subareas, and CB did not demonstrate competence in more than a specific sub-area, or the cluster includes a sub-area that requires specific critical competence that could not be demonstrated by the CB.

6. REQUIREMENTS

6.1 GENERAL

6.1.1 Legal And Contractual Matters

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.1 apply.

6.1.2 Management Of Impartiality

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.2 apply.

6.1.3 Liability And Financing

All the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.3 apply

6.2 STRUCTURAL REQUIREMENTS

All the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 6 apply.

7. RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS

7.1 Competence of personnel

7.1.1 General Considerations

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 7.1.1 apply.

7.1.2 Determination Of Competence Criteria

The certification body shall define the competence requirements for each certification function as referenced in ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Table A.1. When defining these competence requirements, the certification body shall take into account all the requirements specified in ISO/IEC 17021-1, as well as those specified in Clauses 4, 5 and 6 of the ISO/IEC 17021-3, that are relevant, as defined by the certification body.

NOTE 1 Annex A provides a summary of the knowledge required for auditing and certification of quality management in organizations.

NOTE 2 ISO 19011 provides information on the principles of auditing.

7.1.2.1 Generic competence requirements

All the requirements given in clause 4 of ISO/IEC 17021-3:2017 apply.

7.1.2.2 Competence requirements for QMS auditors and audit teams

All the requirements given in clause 5 of ISO/IEC 17021-3:2017 apply.

7.1.2.3 Competence requirements for other personnel

All the requirements given in clause 6 of ISO/IEC 17021-3:2017 apply.

8. INFORMATION REQUIREMENTS

8.1 Public Information

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.1 apply.

8.2 Certification Documents

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.2 apply.

8.3 Reference To Certification and Use of Marks

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.3 apply.

8.4 Confidentiality

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.4 apply.

8.5 Information Exchange Between a Certification Body and Its Clients

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.5 apply.

9. PROCESS REQUIREMENTS

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 9 apply.

10. MANAGEMENT SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS FOR CERTIFICATION BODIES

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 10 apply.

11. ACCREDITATION ASSESSMENTS

The accreditation assessment depends upon the following factors:

- a. The applied IAF Codes/Scopes, including critical codes.

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- b. Key locations and other operational non-key locations.
- c. Countries in which UAF-accredited certificates may be issued.
- d. Existing accreditation by other Accreditation Bodies.
- e. Other certification or conformity assessment activities carried out by the Certification Body
- f. Other relevant details provided in the application.

12. ASSESSMENTS

- a. Document Review
- b. Initial Office Assessments
- c. Witness Assessments.
- d. Remote Assessments
- e. Scope Verifications during extraordinary circumstances.

13. INITIAL ASSESSMENTS

The assessment extent and content depend on the requested scope of accreditation, the other activities for which the body is accredited or requests accreditation and the performance of the body at previous assessments.

The assessment consists of the following activities:

- Document Review
- Office assessment
- Witness Assessments

An application for initial accreditation or extension of scope should at least include each of the following:

- Details of terminology and technology specific to the technical area.
- Statutory and regulatory requirements applicable to the product or service specific to the technical area.
- Characteristics of products, services and processes specific to the technical area.
- The infrastructure and environment for the operation of processes affecting product and service quality.
- The provision of externally provided processes, products and services.
- The impact of organization type, size, governance, structure, functions and relationships on developing and implementing the QMS, its documented information and certification activities.

During the initial assessment, the policies and the procedures implemented by the body are assessed at their office(s). The assessment team makes specimen files of certification staff for every activity to screen the service for the scope of accreditation. At least one certification personnel for each certification function for each IAF code/group and one auditor per IAF code/group requested shall be reviewed completely for award of accreditation of scopes subjected to witness completion in that particular IAF cluster as per the requirements of IAF MD 17.

14. WITNESS ASSESSMENTS

The Certification Body (CB) shall be subject to witness assessment of its ISO 9001 certification activities as part of initial accreditation or extension of scope.

Generally, at least two weeks prior to the witness assessment, the CB shall provide UAF with the following information and records:

- a. Records of the CB's contract review for the selected organization, including qualification and competence records of the auditors and technical experts assigned.
- b. A copy of the ISO 9001 certificate issued by the CB, where a surveillance or recertification audit is to be witnessed.
- c. Where the CB is already accredited by an IAF Full Member Accreditation Body, previous witness assessment reports may be considered subject to review. In such cases, UAF may verify the authenticity and validity of the witness reports directly with the issuing Accreditation Body. This verification is procedural in nature and does not imply any concern regarding the CB's operations or prior assessments.
- d. The report of the CB's document review, pre-assessment or readiness assessment (or the most recent assessment report), together with the audit plan.

For the minimum number of audits to be witnessed, the requirements of IAF MD 17 shall apply. The following may be considered in deciding the number of witnesses and selection of witnesses during surveillance and reassessment:

- a. The CB's overall performance.
- b. IAF MD 17
- c. Factors such as process complexity or legislation influence the certified organization's ability to demonstrate its ability to meet the intended outcome of the MS.
- d. Feedback from interested parties, including complaints about certified organizations.
- e. The results of the CB's internal audit(s).
- f. Scheme owner requirements, etc.
- g. Change(s) in CB work patterns – work growth within a specific region or technical area.
- h. Number of clients within the CB's scope of accreditation.
- i. Confidence in the CB's auditor evaluation and approval process.
- j. Previous or other office or witnessing assessment results, etc.

In addition to the above criteria for selection of audits to be witnessed, UAF may also consider the following:

- a. UAF will normally avoid witnessing auditors who have already been witnessed for the same scheme.
- b. UAF will normally avoid witnessing audits at the same organization.
- c. UAF will review the CB's audit report as part of the witness assessment.
- d. To enable selection of audits for witnessing, the CB shall, upon request, provide audit planning information for a defined period. This information shall include, as a minimum:
 - Type of audit (initial, surveillance, or recertification)
 - Name and address of the auditee
 - Audit standard(s)
 - Scope of certification
 - Names of auditor(s) and technical expert(s)
 - Date(s) of the audit

15. SURVEILLANCE AND REASSESSMENTS

The surveillance assessments of the Certification Body's ISO 9001 certification activities shall normally be conducted annually or as defined in the assessment program, or earlier where justified by the assessment team based on identified risks, changes, or performance concerns. The duration and scope of surveillance assessments shall be determined through a risk-based assessment program, considering the volume, complexity, and maturity of the ISO 9001 certification activities.

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The number and type of witness assessments during surveillance shall be determined in accordance with the assessment program in line with IAF MD 17, accreditation standard requirements and UAF-PL:2019-07-01 — UAF Policy on accreditation scopes & witnessing activities for accreditation of management system CB. Witnessing decisions and number of witnesses may vary considering the outcomes of certification file reviews, sector complexity, use of technical experts, and changes to personnel or processes.

During each surveillance assessment, UAF shall verify the continued effective implementation of the ISO 9001 certification scheme, including compliance with ISO/IEC 17021-3 and applicable accreditation requirements.

Certification files reviewed during surveillance and reassessment shall be selected using a risk-based sampling methodology. The sampling approach may consider:

- Number of ISO 9001 certificates issued since the previous assessment
- Organization size, complexity and other factors
- Levels of risk
- Use of ICT or remote assessment techniques
- Previous nonconformities or complaints

The files reviewed during subsequent surveillance and the reassessment within four years (accreditation cycle) shall comply with the requirements of IAF MD 17. The number of files selected may be increased where higher risk is identified. This is approximately one quarter of the square root of the number of certificates, with a maximum of 18 files and a minimum of one file. The number of files to be reviewed may increase depending on risk-based parameters detailed in the assessment program.

Where applicable, witness assessments may be planned to cover multiple schemes (e.g. combined audits with other standards), provided that it ensures adequate coverage of ISO 9001 specific competence and assessment objectives.

Applying the above guidelines shall consider whether witness assessments may serve multiple schemes (e.g. through witnessing combined audits) and how such witness assessments are performed in other schemes. The accreditation cycle will be for four years, and the reaccreditation assessment should be carried out at least four months before the accreditation expiry. The assessment plan will be listed in the assessment program and updated as required.

16. SCOPE EXTENSION

The assessment by UAF in case of an application for an additional scope cluster consists of one or more of the following assessment methods:

- a. Documents and records review.
- b. Verification of documents and records and interviews of relevant staff during a visit to the office of the CB.
- c. A witness assessment in the technical cluster as per UAF's witness policy document in line with IAF MD 17 requirements.

At least the defined requirements for competence in that technical cluster, records of the qualification process of auditors for that cluster, and a complete certification dossier in that cluster will be verified in the scope extension assessment.

17. SCOPES AND TECHNICAL CLUSTER DETAILS FOR AWARD OF QMS ACCREDITATION

S.No	Technical Cluster	IAF Code /Gro up	Description of economic sector/activity, according to IAF ID1	Critical Code (s)
1.	Food	01	Agriculture, forestry and fishing	03
		03	Food products, beverages and tobacco	
		30	Hotels and restaurants	
2.	Mechanical	17	Limited to "Fabricated metal products"	20 or 22
		18	Machinery and equipment	
		19	Electrical and optical equipment	
		20	Shipbuilding	
		22	Other transport equipment	
3.	Paper	07	Limited to "Paper products"	09
		08	Publishing companies	
		09	Printing companies	
4.	Minerals	02	Mining and quarrying	02 or 15
		15	Non-metallic mineral products	
		16	Concrete, cement, lime, plaster, etc.	
5.	Construction	28	Construction	28
		34	Engineering services	
6.	Goods Production	04	Textiles and textile products	05 or 14
		05	Leather and leather products	
		06	Wood and wood products	
		14	Rubber and plastic products	
		23	Manufacturing not elsewhere classified	
7.	Chemicals	07	Limited to "Pulp and paper manufacturing."	12
		10	Manufacture of coke and refined petroleum products	
		12	Chemicals, chemical products and fibres	
8.	Supply	25	Electricity supply	26
		26	Gas supply	
		27	Water supply	
9.	Transport & Waste management	31	Transport, storage and communication	24
		24	Recycling	
		39	Other social services	
10.	Services	29	Wholesale and retail trade; Repair of motor vehicles, motorcycles and personal and household goods	37 or 33
		32	Financial intermediation, real estate, renting	
		33	Information technology	
		35	Other services	



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		37	Education	
		36	Public administration	
11.	Nuclear	11	Nuclear fuel	11
12.	Pharmaceutical	13	Pharmaceuticals	13
13.	Aerospace	21	Aerospace	21
14.	Health	38	Health and social work	38